

STATCAN Format/Additional Columns

DGUID stands for Dissemination Geography Unique Identifier. It is a combination of reference year, region type, and geographic code to link other geographic mappings in the database. For example, the alphanumeric code 2021A000212 (2021-A-0002-12) has first four numbers for the year, letter 'A' for legally recognized area, and next four numbers represent the provincial area, and finally 12 represents the province of Nova Scotia. This is how DGUID code uniquely identifies specific geographic boundary in Canada.

VECTOR: When StatCan creates a data table, they deal with multiple intersecting dimensions (Geography, Subject, Attributes). A very specific metric over 20 years without downloading a 5GB table, you call its unique Vector ID. For example, a high-digit vector block like v1446859608 belongs to a hyper-specific slice of an active StatCan data cube.

To understand exactly how it surfaces in a real spreadsheet file, consider how it isolates data points step-by-step:

- The Parent Table (Data Cube): Table 14-10-0287-01 (Labour force characteristics by month).
- The Geography Dimension: Canada
- The Demographics Dimension: Youths (Ages 15 to 24)
- The Data Type Dimension: Unemployment Rate
- The Adjustment Dimension: Seasonally Adjusted

Instead of writing out "Canada; Youths 15-24; Unemployment Rate; Seasonally Adjusted" on every single row of a database file, StatCan assigns that exact, unique intersection a single reference token: v1446859608

COORDINATE is a series of numbers separated by periods (e.g., 1.1.1.36.1) that represents the precise lookup coordinates of a data point inside a multi-dimensional table. Each number tells you which specific sub-category (dimension member) is selected across the table's rows and columns.

DECIMALS: The specific decimal precision field. It tells software tools exactly how many decimal places to show when displaying the raw data point value.

SCALAR Factor: This just simplifies the big numbers into small ones. For example, if a raw value is 6123000, the value can be written as 6.123 with corresponding Scalar Factor entry as millions and Decimal column as 3.

SCALAR_ID: The underlying numeric code assigned to that scale. For example, a code of 0 means units (multiply raw value by 1), 3 means thousands, and 6 means millions.

Status: A code tracking data availability and reliability flags. For example, 'A' for excellent quality, 'X' for suppressed to protect confidentiality, or 'E' for use with caution.

Symbol: An internal text field used to assign specific statistical characters alongside a data point (like a footnote indicator) when data is missing or requires special qualification.

Double Dot .. represents a placeholder for a data point that has not been added yet.

Terminal (Terminated): A Boolean flag field (indicated by 0 or 1). A 0 indicates the data series is active and ongoing; a 1 means the historical data series has been discontinued and will no longer receive new data updates.

UOM stands for unit of measure. For example, the units of Value are Dollars, Kilograms, and Tonnes.

UOM_ID represents the ID of a unit of measure. For example, 81 is the UOM_ID when UOM is Dollar.

Unadjusted data: the raw numbers collected for a specific time.

Seasonally adjusted data is the data left after Taking out raw numbers those removes predictable, calendar-based yearly ups and downs (like winter weather slow-downs or holiday shopping spikes)